

Giles Currington

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Summary

I'm a lead product designer with deep UX, UI and service design experience across the design lifecycle. I use pragmatic, just-enough design and research to navigate ambiguity, go from 0-1, and deliver business and user value quickly and iteratively.

I've launched and iterated on products and services including consumer mobile apps, B2B SaaS, marketplaces and subscriptions - working across sectors from Edtech, Travel, and Environment, to Fintech and Legaltech.

I've also built, managed and mentored healthy teams and communities of practice in start-ups and scale-ups, embedding user-centred design approaches within organisations and setting up design and designers to succeed.

Skills and experience

Research and discovery — Quantitative and qualitative, primary and secondary research and data analysis, hypothesis-driven design, learning by doing.

Product and business strategy — Identifying opportunities and risks, design futures and product vision, prioritisation, scope definition and stakeholder management.

Service and UX design — Digital and hybrid services, information architecture, journey maps, service blueprints.

Product and interaction design — UI design, prototyping, accessibility, usability testing.

Design leadership — DesignOps, communities of practice, coaching and mentoring, progression, performance and change management.

Work history

JAN '22 – PRESENT

Lead Product Designer — MyTutor, B2C Marketplace & B2B SaaS Edtech scale-up

Co-led a team of 10 product and brand designers, and led design for a range of teams and end-user groups including customers, suppliers, and internal operations teams.

- **Helped raise £4M funding** with discovery for a learner-focused product strategy that diversifies our offering and serves a greater range of learner and business needs.
- Co-led design for **new platform and subscription model which increased cohort lifetime revenue by up to 40%**, including internal operations platform, customer-facing platform and marketplace, and tutor experience.
- Designed **generative AI learning product with weekly returning learner rate of over 50%**.
- **Line-managed 5 designers**, and co-led design department of 10 product and brand designers - including managing team health and communities of practice, hiring, team structure and change management.

AUG '21 – NOV '21

Product Design Lead — Candide, B2B SaaS & B2C mobile Gardens start-up

Lead design for B2B SaaS for garden venues, mentoring and line managing 2 product designers, and implementing user-centred design processes and practices across the company.

- Launched a **UK-wide B2B2C contactless booking and entry service** that enabled gardens including Blenheim Palace and The Newt to stay open during the pandemic.
- Piloted an **interactive mobile garden tour at the Eden Project**.
- Designed an upgrade service that **converted more visitors to members and reduced time-to-serve**.

JUL '19 – JUL '21

Product Designer — Candide, B2B SaaS & B2C mobile Gardens start-up

Design new and existing products and services within the 'Gardens' business area and across the wider business. Identify opportunities through generative research, test ideas by prototyping, design and deliver products and services to market in an iterative and agile way.

- Launched a **B2C and C2C in-app marketplace** for garden products and services.
- Designed new community interactions and features for a **consumer mobile app**.

AUG '18 – JUL '19

Lead/Senior UX/UI Designer — Freelance, Giles Currington Ltd

Work with agencies, startups and brands on digital products and services, from concept creation and research, user journeys and information architecture to visual design and prototyping.

- UX/UI Lead for **legal/financial services platform MVP** at Neverbland
- Product & Service design for **sustainable business models and service opportunities** for Shell subsidiaries at !WhatIf?
- Senior UX for **Ford Motor's B2C and B2B web platforms** at VML

SEP '17 – JUL '18

UX/UI Designer — We are Why Studio, Digital agency

Digital products for clients including Barclays bank, conducting user research, UX design, visual design and prototyping. Work collaboratively with clients using design sprints and iterative processes to create, adapt and improve products and services.

- Discovery and design for **Barclays bank consumer mobile app** product exploration to support Open Banking.

SEP '15 – AUG '16

UX/UI Designer — August Media, Digital agency

Integral part of agile design team working across large-scale e-commerce builds, responsive sites, and hybrid and native apps. UX, UI, and visual design

- **Content platform and E-commerce site** for the Goodwood Estate.
- **Responsive web platform** for The Where Pass international travel card.

NOV '13 – SEP '15

Lead UX/UI designer — Contentment, mobile app publishing start-up

Lead the design team in the design and development of digital products, with a focus on responsive HTML5 apps. Also responsible for the rebrand and positioning update.

- **Mobile HTML5 apps** for publishers including Conde Nast

Training and conferences

UX London
Service Design & Innovation Intensive – UAL
Mind The Product – London
Smashing Magazine – RWD Workshop
Guardian Masterclasses – Designing digital magazines
General Assembly – Designing for multiple devices
The Next Web Conference – Amsterdam

Education

University of Leeds – BA Graphic & Communication Design